

moon does change in a little less than every four days, and so far the strikes match the nights when there was a change in the phase of the moon.

DEVELOPMENTS

Should the adventurers have more questions they wish answered, perhaps because they are having trouble putting the disparate pieces together, Delacrae can do further research for another 2 sp and five hours. The price becomes 1 gp if they wish her to work through the night hours because the party is in a rush.

Delacrae becomes another useful tool for the Dungeon Master to help the adventurers, particularly if the players are having trouble with their investigation.

FILLISTROM WUNDERKUNDOODLE

If the adventurers wish to follow-up with the healer that Knight Aleyd Burrall spoke with, they are directed to his shop.

A wooden board displaying a bandaged hand hangs in over a small storefront with window boxes full of flowers. A balding gnomish man with a crown of limp white hair is carefully pulling herbs from between the flowers and placing them into a small basket at his feet.

Seeing the party's approach, Fillistrom sizes them up quickly as adventurers and offers to answer their questions for a consulting fee of 5 sp (though he is willing to negotiate down to 1 sp if they adventurers try). Once a fee is agreed upon, he invites them into his cramped shop. Books line the walls and various healing herbs hang from the ceiling as they dry.

ROLEPLAYING FILLISTROM

Fillistrom Wunderkundoodle is cranky male gnome with a penchant for taking his time. Fillistrom is a trained healer who studies the mysteries of the body and is a competent mundane healer for those without the means to afford magical remedies or with a distrust of the magic.

Fillistrom readily admits that the bones that the knight brought him appeared to be phalanges (toe bones) from an adult human. They are quite old, and are stained from where muscle and skin rotted atop them. If the adventurers wish to see them he can produce them. Digging in a nearby trunk, he pulls out a jar with a few small bones.

- The bones do not radiate magic.
- Looking closely at them and success in a DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check, a character notices a sticky residue on several of the bones. It appears to be some kind of natural adhesive, possibly a tree sap (This is left over from when the kobolds stuck the bones to their costumes.)
- The bones were kobolds gathered from random corpses they dug up. If magic is used to determine the owners of the bones or cause of death, they are three different corpses who died of natural causes.

FACTION ASSIGNMENTS

Those adventurers who are members of the Order of the Gauntlet, the Emerald Enclave, or the Lords' Alliance can take advantage of their organization's network of informants to gain additional information and assignments.

ORDER OF THE GAUNTLET

Members of the Order of the Gauntlet are able to contact the brash Zern Xerkstil, the Hammer of Impiltur (male half-orc) who asks to meet at the Dawn Fane, an abandoned temple. The Order of the Gauntlet is concerned about the rise of fell cults in the Moonsea region. He believes that there is something more infernal to these rumors of undead than other might believe. **Zern offers the adventurer the loan of a silver hand axe;** useful for decapitating vampires and fiends from the lower Hells!

Assignment. Take the silver axe and see if you can find proof of infernal cults. The adventurers are ordered to destroy any undead or fiends encountered in course of their duties. Proof of undead and/or infernal corruption should then be returned to Zern.

Success Condition. Bringing back the corpse of the lemure, or the tainted pirates, or arresting any of the Folk who are devil worshippers (Warsh, Ulburto, or the crones) fulfills the requirements for success in the Order of the Gauntlet faction assignment.

EMERALD ENCLAVE

Members of the Emerald Enclave are able to contact the reclusive Seranolla the Whisperer (female forest gnome) who asks to meet outside the city in the woods. The Emerald Enclave have determined that something unnatural is going on with the weather and storms seem to spring up every four days, corresponding directly with changes in the phase of the moon. Whatever is doing it

is disrupting both ships and some of the sea life.

Assignment. End the cause of the inclement weather.

Success Condition. Destroying the dracolich statue or giving it to the Kelemvorites to use and eventually destroy fulfills the requirements for success in the Emerald Enclave faction assignment.

LORD'S ALLIANCE

Members of the Lord's Alliance are able to contact the gregarious Dornal Whitebeard (male hill dwarf), who asks to meet at the Velvet Doublet, a well-known feasthall. The Lord's Alliance believes a merchant, Gilfron Milon, is missing. He is overdue and may be in trouble. He should be somewhere on the Iron Route to the southwest. Once you find him, help him as needed to ensure that he continues on his way to Phlan from Hillsfar.

Assignment. Travel on the Iron Route and find Gilfron Milon. Assist as needed.

Success Condition. Finding Gilfron and helping him get back on the road fulfills the requirements for success in the Lord's Alliance faction assignment.

PART 2: ON THE ROAD

Once the adventurers have enough information to proceed out of Phlan towards the suspected site of the next raid, they have three brief encounters on the road before making it to the fishing village. This part assumes the adventurers spent the night in Phlan and left the morning of the sixteenth day. If that is not the case, the Dungeon Master may need to alter the descriptions of light and the gathering storm as appropriate.

OF GHOST SHIPS & ROAST DUCK

The Iron Route, the main road along the north side of the Moonsea runs all the way from Zhentil Keep to Phlan and beyond. Travel along it is swift and generally safe, at least as far as can be expected to be in the violent and unpredictable Moonsea region. With the sun high above gathering storm clouds you find yourself out of Phlan and well on your way West, when you should chance to come across a wagon pulled to the side of the road with a broken axel. A young human boy tends a campfire while a man in merchant clothing digs in the back of the wagon.

ROLEPLAYING GILFRON MILON

Gilfron Milon is a friendly male human merchant who deals in lumber from the Quivering Forest and tools. While he is pleasant, he is no fool and knows the roads are dangerous, leaving him cautious at the outset of any meeting. Since his wife died of a fever three years ago, he travels in the company of his son Gilmont. He speaks with a false educated air, pretending to be of higher class than he is.

Gilfron makes his living leading caravans of goods to and from Phlan with the help of his son Gilmont. They are currently headed to Phlan from Hillsfar, and have a wagon filled with axes, saws, pulleys, and other metal tools useful in working lumber, along with a smattering of southern goods unavailable on the northern bank of the Moonsea.

Gilfron is friendly, but both father and son are wary when a large group of armed travelers approach them. As soon it becomes clear the adventurers are no threat, they happily invite them to share a midday meal. Should the adventurers instead choose to threaten him, Gilfron tells his son to run while he does his best to distract the brutes, though he is no threat.

Over a roast duck or while tied up, Gilfron can relate the following:

- Gilfron owns a handful of wagons, and leading caravans laden with goods for sale and trade all along the coast of the Moonsea. Sometimes he carries back orders for particularly large shipments which can also be sent by boat, but usually he uses the Iron Route.
- Recently he has seen a lot of raided villages and home. At the village just two days away he saw the ruins still smoldering like all the others. He avoided going into the ruined villages, not knowing if there are raiders about. All of the homes and villagers were there and occupied when he passed the other way three months ago, but he saw no living souls this time.
- The only sign of civilization the pair saw was the island ferry about a day back. The fisher folk have always been a strange and isolated kin who don't much mix with others, but he spoke with the boatman and loosened his tongue with a new hammer and some nails that the man needed to use to repair his ferry. The boatman said he was more worried about the storm coming in the next day or so, than he was about any rumors of a dracolich haunting they area. Gilfron notes that in Stormy Bay, storms coming in off the sea are all too common. Undead dragons are not.
- Worried for his boy, Gilfron further enquired as to why the boatman had mentioned a dracolich, the strange man gave him a long stare and said that there has been a plague of those with fragile minds of late, spouting such tales. In fact his island village sheltered one such soul now who had wandered to the ferry stop two days ago. The man had seen something that has made him loose his mind and spout on about the "eyes of the dracolich" watching him wear ever he goes. The boatman felt that the vagrant was clearly weak and confused.

At the age of 10, Gilmont is used to his father doing most of the talking and instead tends to watch from the background. Should an adventurer approach him for his side of the story, he confirms much of what his father says, but notes one additional detail. As they drove away, he noted that the boatman made a strange digging-like gesture with his left hand, sort of like pointing towards the ground with his pinkie and forefinger. A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check allows the adventurer to recognize the gesture as typically used in spells that protect against creatures from other planes. By itself, the gesture does nothing and possesses no magic.

FIXING THE AXEL

If any of the adventurers are willing to help Gilfron repair his wagon, he is greatly appreciative. He does not have a spare, but there are ample trees and he does have woodworking tools. A successful DC 15 Strength check can rig a temporary repair that should see him to Phlan.

If helped in this way, he is only too happy to accept any business offers from members of the Lords' Alliance.

A WARY MOTHER

Before night falls, a stiff wind than smells of rain whips up and the adventurers cross paths with a mother wolf and her cubs.

A high pitch yipping accompanied by a rustling in a roadside bushes is the only warning you get before a wolf pup runs into the road ahead of you. It is followed a heartbeat later by a second pup that tackles the first in the road.

The heartwarming roughhousing is broken by the sound of a deep and much louder growling from behind you.

The wolf pups were playing, and one has chased the other out of the bushes where it finally caught its sibling. Wrestling in the road, they are unaware of the adventurers who stand only 15 feet away. Unfortunately for the adventurers, the mother dire wolf has caught scent of the adventurers and moved quietly in their direction in the hedges 10 feet behind the party.

Any adventurer riding a mount that is not trained for war (such as the riding horses provided by Yovir) must succeed on a DC 10 Wisdom (Animal Handling) check as the animal catches the scent of the mother wolf. Failure on this check means that that adventurer's horse rears up in panic and throws its rider unless that adventurer also succeeds at a DC 10 Dexterity saving throw. An adventurer who is thrown from their horse suffers 4 (1d8) bludgeoning damage.

The mother **dire wolf** has let out a warning growl, but given that the adventurers outnumber her and they are in between her pups and her, she has not yet attacked. Any attempt to move toward her or the pups causes the wolf to attack. Otherwise the adventurers can attempt to move away in a calm manner to avoid the combat. A successful DC 15 Wisdom (Animal Handling) is needed to move away from the wolves without angering the wary mother further. If multiple adventurers try to calm her, she attacks if any of the adventurers fail.

If a combat begins, the pups flee and the mother dire wolf attacks the nearest adventurer. One full round after

the pups are clear, she also breaks and runs into the brush. If at any point someone attacks one of the pups or gives chase to them, the mother focuses solely on that individual to the detriment of her own safety and life.

The pups (AC 11) are noncombatants and are slain if they take 5 points or more of damage. They count as allies for the purpose of the mother dire wolf's *pack tactics* ability.

GENERAL FEATURES

The road is a five foot wide dirt track with a hedgerow along one side and scattered trees to the other.

Light: The sun is about an hour from setting, so while the sky is overcast. Treat the area as bright light.

Bushes: The thick hedges are ten feet thick and run forty feet both ahead and behind the starting position of the adventurers. They are difficult terrain and heavily obscure anyone on side from the other.

Trees: The trees are narrow, less than one foot thick. Keeping a tree between yourself and an enemy provides half cover.

ADJUSTING THE ADVENTURE

Here are recommendations for adjusting this combat encounter. These are not cumulative.

- **Very weak or weak party:** the dire wolf has 19 hit points
- **Strong or very strong party:** the dire wolf has 60 hit points

THE BOATMAN

The party is able to camp without incident, but the weather has continued to worsen. Shortly after setting out that morning they arrive at the ferry landing.

The first morning since you left Phlan dawns very windy and drizzling. The sea churns with Umberlee's wrath and an elderly man with a wild beard, salt encrusted coat, and floppy hat struggles to bring a large flat bottomed raft to shore. He pulls arm-over-arm along a rope, which is strung between the shore and a small island an arrowshot into the bay.

ROLEPLAYING WARSH THE BOATMAN

Warsh is a foul-tempered old man with one squinting eye and the other unnaturally bulging. He clenches a battered pipe between his teeth at all times, making it even harder to understand his already angry, mumbled speech. His family has lived on the island for five generations before him and he was there when the town made its pact with Tiamat. He is superstitious of outsiders, mean, and very greedy. It is also his job to deal with non-islanders.

Having seen the party approach, Warsh has brought the ferry from the island to see what they want. While he strongly recommends against anyone going to the island, he can always be bought for 1 gp a head and 1 sp for each mount, pet or livestock the adventurers may have with them.

Warsh viciously insults characters that claim to be pirates or have the look of a pirate about them (possibly the pirate background), and charges them triple fare.

TALKING WITH WARSH

Warsh isn't especially interested in conversation, but if pressed he can offer a few dire words or mumbled insults before demanding the adventurers either pay him for passage or leave him to pull his way back to the island.

- An angry storm is coming. Someday the sea will claim its due and wash all of the ignorant shore folk into its depths.
- There is nothing to see on the island and no reason to visit the village. The adventurers should look elsewhere for their entertainment.
- If they insist on coming to the island, they will have to stay until after the storm passes to leave, as Warsh will not risk another trip until the seas calm.
- Warsh is suspicious of everyone including the madman they currently shelter, so if the adventurers ask about him, Warsh readily admits to having him on the island hoping the party means to take him away. Warsh describes the man as having the look of sailor about him, but raving about the "eyes of the dracolich" or other such nonsense. The man is otherwise healthy, so Warsh believes the man witnessed something his mind couldn't handle and snapped as opposed to someone who has wandered the wilderness in his insanity for a long time.

DEVELOPMENTS

Should the adventurers be unwilling or unable to pay Warsh, he leaves them stranded on the shore. He is willing to barter however, and he will take a good blade or some food or spirits in trade. If the adventurers still refuse his help, they can try to swim the distance, though it is clearly a fool's errand. It is 600 feet through stormy seas, requiring many successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) checks to make it there.